

The New Legal Marketing Manager's Playbook

**A 90-DAY GUIDE TO WINNING
IN LEGAL MARKETING**

Rankings 

Welcome to Legal Marketing.

It's a Different Animal.

You might have come into this role thinking: “Marketing is marketing. I’ll figure it out.”

Then you get into it and realize:



“I didn’t realize how much of this is local.”



“I thought SEO was just content.”



“I didn’t know reviews mattered this much.”



“I feel like I’m missing context.”

And suddenly, what worked in your last role doesn’t translate as neatly as you expected.

This Isn't "Just Marketing in a Different Industry"

A lot of people step into legal marketing with strong experience and a good instinct for what works.

Then you get into it, and you realize there's another layer to everything.

The stakes feel higher. The competition is tighter. And the path from "we're doing marketing" to "we're signing cases we actually want" is not always straightforward.

The Most Important Shift

Traffic, impressions, and activity can look strong on paper and still not translate into the right cases.

What matters here is qualified leads, signed cases, and visibility for the practice areas you're trying to grow.

Getting clear on that early makes every decision easier.

1. What are we trying to grow?

Step 1: Ask:

"If we could sign more of one type of case this quarter, what would it be?"

Step 2: Write it down

Primary case type:

Secondary case type (if any):

If You Only Take Away One Thing:

Legal marketing is about capturing **high-intent demand** and turning it into signed cases.

SEO Is More Than Blogging

A lot of teams start with content. Blogs, pages, adding keywords.

That's part of it, but SEO in legal goes deeper pretty quickly.

Site performance, authority, content depth, local signals, and how your firm shows up across the web all play a role in whether you're visible for the cases you want.

The Most Important Shift

SEO works best when it's tied directly to your case goals.

That means understanding what's currently driving leads, what's supporting the right case types, and where you're missing opportunities.

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2. What is our SEO actually doing?

Step 1: Ask your SEO partner or team:

"We want to sign more [case type] cases.
What are we doing right now to support that?"

Step 2: Write it down

Current SEO focus:

**If You Only Take Away
One Thing:**

Strong SEO helps your firm
show up when someone is
looking for the **exact service**
you offer.

Local Search Determines Whether the Phone Rings

One of the biggest surprises for people new to legal marketing is how much comes down to local visibility.

When someone needs an attorney, they're usually searching in the moment and choosing from what shows up first.

Your Google Business Profile, map-pack visibility, categories, and listing consistency all play into that.

The Most Important Shift

Local search shows up right at the decision point.

When your firm is visible there, you're part of the conversation.
When you're not, someone else is getting that call.



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3. How competitive are we locally?

Step 1: Search your top case type + city

Example: "car accident lawyer [city]"

Step 2: Look at what shows up

Are we in the map pack?

Action:

Google your top case type + city right now.
Screenshot the map pack.
That's your real competition.

Are our categories aligned with our main case types?

If You Only Take Away One Thing:

Map-pack visibility is one of the most **direct paths** to new cases.

Reviews Are a Growth Lever

Reviews come up in almost every conversation for a reason.

They influence whether someone trusts you, whether they call, and how your firm shows up in local results.

They also feed into how platforms interpret your reputation over time.

The Most Important Shift

A steady flow of reviews builds momentum.

Firms that consistently generate reviews tend to strengthen both visibility and trust at the same time.

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4. Do we have a review strategy?

Step 1: Ask:

“How are we asking clients for reviews right now?”

Step 2: Write it out

Current process:

How often are new reviews coming in?

Action: Identify one recent client you could text today and ask for a review. Are our categories aligned with our main case types?

If You Only Take Away One Thing:

Consistent, high-quality reviews support both **rankings** and **conversions**.

Platform Ownership Impacts What You Can Do

This is one that catches people off guard.

It's easy to assume you have full control over your website, content, and data.

In legal, there are often limitations tied to platforms, contracts, or how things were originally set up.

The Most Important Shift

Understanding what you have access to helps you plan realistically.

It also helps avoid surprises when you want to make changes or shift direction.



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5. What do we actually have access to?

Step 1: Ask your vendor or team:

Do we have backend access?

Can we export our data?

If You Only Take Away One Thing:

Clarity around ownership makes long-term planning **much easier.**

You Need Visibility Into Your Data

A lot of firms are used to seeing reports or dashboards.

That's helpful, but it doesn't always give the full picture.

Having access to your actual platforms allows you to understand where leads come from and how they turn into cases.

The Most Important Shift

Clear data helps you make confident decisions.

It also makes conversations with partners or stakeholders much more straightforward.

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6. Do we have full visibility?

Do we have access to Google Analytics?

Do we know where leads are coming from?

Can we connect leads to signed cases?

**If You Only Take Away
One Thing:**

Direct access to your data
gives you a **clearer view of
what's working.**

AI Visibility Is Already Showing Up

AI-driven search is starting to influence how firms are discovered and evaluated.

People are asking questions in new ways and getting summarized answers instead of traditional results.

The Most Important Shift

Your online presence now contributes to how your firm is interpreted, not just listed.

Clear content, strong signals, and consistent information all support how you show up. If your online presence is inconsistent, AI reflects that inconsistency.



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7. Are we showing up in AI results?

Search your practice areas in tools like Google or ChatGPT.

Are you mentioned?

Who is showing up?

If You Only Take Away One Thing:

Your firm's **online footprint** shapes how AI platforms understand and present you.

Brand Is Built on Trust and Clarity

Brand in legal tends to show up through reputation, experience, and focus.

People are looking for signals that they're choosing the right firm.

The Most Important Shift

Clear positioning helps people remember you and feel confident reaching out.

Firms that communicate what they do well tend to stand out more easily.

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8. What are we known for?

What do we want to be known for?

What supports that (cases, results, experience)?

Is that reflected in our marketing?

**If You Only Take Away
One Thing:**

Being known for something
specific makes **decision-**
making easier for
potential clients.

Social Works Best With Direction

Posting regularly can feel productive, and it does keep your firm active.

The biggest gains usually come from having a clear direction behind the content.

The Most Important Shift



Content that builds familiarity tends to perform better over time.

That includes attorney presence, stories, and helpful insights that connect with real situations.

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9. What is our content doing?

Are people engaging with posts?

Do we have clear themes?

If You Only Take Away One Thing:

Engagement tends to follow **clarity** and **consistency**.

Growth Comes From Multiple Touchpoints

Most firms rely heavily on one or two channels.

The firms that continue to grow tend to show up in more than one place throughout the decision process.

The Most Important Shift

People often recognize a firm before they reach out.

That familiarity builds through multiple interactions over time.

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10. Where are we showing up?

Top-of-funnel (awareness):

Mid-funnel (consideration):

Bottom-of-funnel (ready to hire):

**If You Only Take Away
One Thing:**

Consistent visibility across
channels supports
stronger results.

Your Role Includes Internal Alignment

A big part of this role happens internally.

Attorneys are focused on cases, outcomes, and running the firm. Marketing often needs translation.

The Most Important Shift

Clear communication makes everything easier.

When everyone is aligned on priorities, decisions move faster and results tend to follow.



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11. Are we aligned?

Do we agree on priority case types?

Is success clearly defined?

If You Only Take Away One Thing:

Alignment makes strategy easier to execute.

Bringing It All Together

At this point, you've seen how many different pieces contribute to growth in legal marketing.

Each section connects back to a few core ideas:



Clear priorities help you decide which case types to invest in, which campaigns to push, and what success should look like each quarter



Visibility at the moment someone is searching determines whether your firm shows up in the map pack, organic results, or not at all



Trust is built through what people can quickly see and verify, including recent reviews, recognizable case types, and a consistent presence across your website and listings



Access to data allows you to see which channels are generating leads, which pages are driving conversions, and how those leads turn into signed cases



Internal alignment helps ensure your attorneys, intake team, and marketing efforts are all focused on the same case types and outcomes

There's a lot to manage, and it doesn't all come together overnight.

Most people in this role are learning in real time—whether you came from a marketing background or stepped into this as part of running the firm.

Progress tends to come from asking better questions, staying focused on outcomes, and building a clearer understanding of how your firm generates cases.

A Final Thought

Legal marketing has a learning curve, and many of the most important details aren't obvious at first.

If you want to keep building on this, join the **[Personal Injury Mastermind \(PIM\) newsletter](#)** for practical insights, real examples from top firms, and strategies you can apply right away.